Jarrod Tran

AI Product Leader | Enterprise AI Deployment

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Summary

Product and operations leader who turns enterprise AI pilots into tools people use every day.
At Tesla Energy, I built and lead the product and engineering team behind 20+ production AI tools with 1,000+ active users, plus the training and adoption reporting that keeps them in use. Before that, I led Apple's iPhone program in India, ran Engineering Operations planning at Waymo, and delivered battery and vehicle programs at Tesla.

Experience

Tesla Energy | Lead, AI Enablement & Factory Strategy

Houston, TX | Aug 2023 to Present

Rejoined Tesla in 2023 after Apple and Waymo.

- Built and lead a 4-person AI product and engineering team that has shipped 20+ production AI tools now used by 1,000+ employees, including RAG-based troubleshooting assistants, automated reporting, workflow automation and decision support.
- Own the roadmap for an AI enablement program reaching 10,000 employees: rank use cases, assign an owner to each, and pair every release with training and weekly adoption reports to leadership.
- Freed an estimated 540 hours per week, worth $1.6M a year in productivity, by funding the tools that save the most time or improve decisions.
- Built the Python and Tableau ROI model executives used to choose among 50+ competing initiatives for a $23M budget; the funded portfolio delivered $156M in incremental annual profit.
- Redesigned the investment plan for Megapack, Tesla's utility-scale battery product, mitigating $550M in projected tariff exposure during a 3.2x scale-up.
- Served as Program Champion for MegaUnleash, a program that delivered $260M in annualized savings.

Waymo | Strategy & Operations Manager

Mountain View, CA | Oct 2022 to May 2023

- Moved six separately planned functions (hardware, software, fleet, Product, Legal and Engineering) onto one Engineering Operations plan, with shared OKRs, resource plans and quarterly business reviews for a 200+ person engineering organization.
- Aligned those six functions on commercial deployment priorities as Waymo's driverless ride service expanded.
- Built the leadership dashboards for fleet health, performance and milestones, cutting one-off reporting requests.

Apple | Strategic Operations Program Manager

Cupertino, CA | Jun 2021 to Jun 2022

- Led the iPhone India program end to end from a standing start, keeping market entry, partner readiness and launch timing on one schedule.
- Supported 293% year-over-year unit growth (4.3M to 16.9M) as program revenue grew from $2B to $10B and exports expanded from 6 to 40+ countries.
- Turned demand forecasts into weekly funding and readiness plans, and raised quality, regulatory and timing risks to leadership.

Tesla | Program Manager, Special Projects

Fremont, CA | Jun 2018 to Jun 2021

- Took Project Roadrunner, Tesla's 4680 battery cell program, from pilot to launch readiness through its public unveiling at Tesla's 2020 Battery Day.
- Led Model 3 and Model Y production planning and recovery for two years from launch, ramping each model to 10,000 units per week and hitting every quarterly production and delivery goal.
- Designed and launched Warehouse on Wheels, a coordination platform managing $3.5M per month in operating expenses.

Amazon | Operations Area Manager

Patterson, CA | Mar 2017 to Apr 2018

Education

University at Buffalo | B.S. Business Administration, Finance | Cum Laude